Filipe Hisao Kobayashi

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Appointments

2024– **University of Salzburg**
Post-doctorate researcher

2023–2024 **University of Pennsylvania**
Lecturer in Syntax/Semantics

Education

Degree programs

2017–2023 **Massachusetts Institute of Technology**
PhD program in Linguistics
Dissertation: "Quantifying over individual concepts"

2016–2017 **University of Toronto**
MA in Hispanic Linguistics

2012–2016 **Universidade Federal do Rio de Janeiro**
BA in Portuguese Language and Literature (Letras)
Thesis: "Possessive time, cessation and lifetime effects"

Summer schools

2019 **DGfS Summer School**, Berlin, Germany

2018 **NASSLLI**, Pittsburgh, USA

Papers

Under revision

2026 "Interpreting NPs as predicates of individual concepts"
Revise and resubmit, *Journal of Semantics*

2026 "Pluralities of individual concepts are needed"
[with Enrico Flor]
Revise and resubmit, *Semantics & Pragmatics*

Book chapters

2026 "Generalizing von Stechow's problem"
In a festschrift for Danny Fox, *MIT Working Papers in Linguistics*

Conference proceedings

2024 "Ignorance under attitudes"
[with Patrick D. Elliott]
Amsterdam Colloquium 2024

2024 "Tracking down (c)overt movement with adverbial distributive numerals in Mandarin Chinese"
[with Sherry Yong Chen]
West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics 39

2021 "Lexically triggered uniqueness in wh-questions: An argument from Brazilian Portuguese"
[with Vincent Rouillard]
Semantics and Linguistic Theory 31

2021 "Two ways of building reciprocity: a study of Mandarin reciprocals"
West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics 38

2021 "Composing reciprocity: An analysis of scattered reciprocals"
Semantics and Linguistic Theory 30

2020 "High and low uniqueness in singular wh-interrogatives"
[with Vincent Rouillard]
Semantics and Linguistic Theory 30

2020 "Tying Free Choice in questions to distributivity" [with Vincent Rouillard]
New Frontiers in Artificial Intelligence (Proceedings of Logic and Engineering of Natural Language Semantics 16)

2020 "Ways of decomposing events: distributive numerals in Mandarin Chinese"
[with Sherry Yong Chen]
Chicago Linguistics Society 55

2020 "Comprehending and: The Acquisition of English Conjunction in Child Language"
[with Sherry Yong Chen, Loes Koring, Cory Bill, Leo Rosenstein and Martin Hackl]
Boston University Conference on Language Development 44

2019 "Coordinating Complete Answers: The Case of Tanto-Quanto Conjunction"
[with Enrico Flor]
Amsterdam Colloquium 2019

2016 "Temporal implicatures and possessive time in Brazilian Portuguese"
Semantics of Under-Represented Languages in the Americas 9

Presentations

Talks

2025 "Building individual concepts structurally"
Ontology As Structured by the Interfaces with Semantics 5

2025 "From NPs to predicates of individual concepts"
Semantics and Linguistic Theory 35

2024 "Nominal Free Choice"
[with Patrick D. Elliott]
MECORE closing workshop

2022 "The logic of Hindi co-compounds"
[with Ido Benbaji and Yash Sinha]
Sinn und Bedeutung 27

2021 "Tracking down (c)overt movement with adverbial distributive numerals in Mandarin Chinese"
[with Sherry Yong Chen]
West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics 39

2021 "Two ways of building reciprocity: a study of Mandarin reciprocals"
West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics 38

2019 "Coordinating Complete Answers: The Case of Tanto-Quanto Conjunction"
[with Enrico Flor]
Amsterdam Colloquium 2019

2019 "Tying Free Choice in questions to distributivity" [with Vincent Rouillard]
Logic and Engineering of Natural Language Semantics 16

2019 "A compositional analysis of scattered reciprocals in Brazilian Portuguese"
Workshop on Cross-Linguistic Semantics of Reciprocals

2019 "Ways of decomposing events: distributive numerals in Mandarin Chinese"
[with Sherry Yong Chen]
Chicago Linguistics Society 55

Posters

2025 "Syntactic constraints on fake indexicals in relative clauses"
[with Caroline Gardner, Franziska Keller, Anita Riedl and Susanne Wurmbrand]
North East Linguistic Society 56

2024 "Ignorance under attitudes"
[with Patrick D. Elliott]
Amsterdam Colloquium 2024

2024 "Quantification uncovered: a reply to Aloni (2001)"
[with Enrico Flor]
Semantics and Linguistic Theory 34

2021 "Which singular *wh*-interrogatives admit plural answers in Brazilian Portuguese"
[with Vincent Rouillard]
Semantics and Linguistic Theory 31

2020 "Getting plural answers from singular complex *wh*-phrases in Brazilian Portuguese"
[with Vincent Rouillard]
Sensus 1

2020 "Composing reciprocity: An analysis of scattered reciprocals"
Semantics and Linguistic Theory 30

2020 "High and low uniqueness in singular *wh*-interrogatives"
[with Vincent Rouillard]
Semantics and Linguistic Theory 30

2020 "Quantifying over thematic roles: Mandarin distributive numerals and reciprocals"
[with Sherry Yong Chen]
Generative Linguistics in the Old World 43

2020 "Comprehension of Conjunction by English-speaking Adults and Children"
[with Sherry Yong Chen, Loes Koring, Cory Bill, Leo Rosenstein and Martin Hackl]
CUNY Conference on Human Sentence Processing 33

2020 "Comprehending and: The Acquisition of English Conjunction in Child Language"
[with Sherry Yong Chen, Loes Koring, Cory Bill, Leo Rosenstein and Martin Hackl]
Boston University Conference on Language Development 44

2019 "Two types of reciprocals in Mandarin Chinese"
Workshop on Cross-Linguistic Semantics of Reciprocals

2018 "Distributive numerals in Mandarin Chinese at the syntax-semantics interface"
[with Sherry Yong Chen]
NASSLLI Student Session

2016 "Temporal implicatures and possessive time in Brazilian Portuguese"
Semantics of Under-Represented Languages in the Americas 9

Invited Talks

2026 "Generalizing von Stechow's problem"
Talk at the Georg-August University Göttingen

2024 "Interpreting NPs as predicates of individual concepts"
Talk at the Leibniz-Zentrum Allgemeine Sprachwissenschaft (ZAS)

2024 "Quantification uncovered"
Meaning in Language colloquium at the Heinrich Heine University Düsseldorf

2024 "Interpreting NPs as predicates of individual concepts"
NYU Semantics Group at the New York University

2024 "Interpreting NPs as predicates of individual concepts"
ILST Seminar in Language and Communication Sciences at the University of Pennsylvania

Teaching experience

Main instructor

2024 Introduction to Formal Linguistics, UPenn (Undergraduate class)

2024 Syntax 2, UPenn (Graduate Class)

2023 Construct a Language, UPenn (Undergraduate class)

2023 Seminar in Syntax and Semantics, UPenn (Graduate class)

2023 Winter Logic Crash-Course, MIT
Co-instructor with Vincent Rouillard
(a two-week logic introduction course)

Summer schools

2026 Modais e condicionais: uma introdução formal
Mini-course, Universidade Federal do Rio de Janeiro

2026 Introduction to comparatives and other degree constructions
OVA summer school

2025 The Morphology, Syntax and Semantics of Fake ϕ-features in pronouns
Co-instructor with Susi Wurmbrand
The NYI Global Institute of Cultural, Cognitive, and Linguistic Studies #10

Teaching Assistantships

2021 Undergraduate Semantics & Pragmatics, MIT
Instructor: Patrick D. Elliott
Responsibilities: weekly recitations, grading, office hours

2020 Introduction to Linguistics, MIT
Instructor: Adam Albright
Responsibilities: weekly recitations, grading, office hours

2019 Introduction to Semantics, MIT
Instructor: Martin Hackl & Roger Schwarzschild
Responsibilities: weekly recitations, office hours

2018 Introduction to Linguistics, MIT
Instructor: Adam Albright
Responsibilities: weekly recitations, grading, office hours

2016 Linguistics III (formal syntax), Federal University of Rio de Janeiro
Instructor: Suzi Lima
Responsibilities: office hours

2015–2016 Linguistics II (phonetics and phonology), Federal University of Rio de Janeiro
Instructor: Gean Nunes Damulakis
Responsibilities: office hours

2015 History of the Portuguese Language, Federal University of Rio de Janeiro
Instructor: Leonardo Lennertz Marcotulio
Responsibilities: office hours

2014 Linguistics III (formal syntax), Federal University of Rio de Janeiro
Instructor: Aleria Lage
Responsibilities: office hours

2014 Intensive Linguistics Course for Indigenous Educators, UNEMAT
Instructor: Prof. Marília Facó Soares
Responsibilities: teaching assistant

Guest lectures

2023 "Interleaving A- & A′-movement: a Brazilian Portuguese case study"
Syntax II, Yale, Instructor: Suzana Fong

2022 "The Dynamics of Plurals"
Topics in Semantics (graduate seminar on anaphora), MIT, Instructor: Patrick D. Elliott

2022 "Interrogative Intruders"
Advanced Semantics, MIT, Instructors: Amy Rose Deal, Martin Hackl

Service

Organizing

2020 Co-founder and co-organizer of the Semantics Triangle, an MIT-Harvard-BU semantics reading group

2019–2020 Co-organizer of LF Reading Group, MIT's semantics reading group

2018–2020 Co-founder and co-organizer of MorPhun, MIT's morphology reading group

2019 Co-organizer of MIT Linguistics' Colloquium Talks

Languages

Brazilian Portuguese native

English fluent

Spanish advanced

(last updated on October 15, 2026)